



FADE THE CHALK

POST-MORTEM

Saturday, June 13, 2026

Five Plays · One Exacta Hit · The Rule That Cost Us \$651

"The model was sharp. Our rules were too tight. We find winners — now we back them."

Final Scorecard

Race	Bet	Stake	Result	Coll.	Net
Gulfstream R4	Exotic Box: 3, 2, 5, 1	\$86.40	3-7-6-1	\$0	-\$86.40
Churchill R8	Exotic Box: 4, 7, 2, 3	\$86.40	3-5-8-1	\$0	-\$86.40
Belmont R10	Exotic Box: 8, 10, 1, 5	\$86.40	2-5-1-11	\$0	-\$86.40
Santa Anita R8	Win: Zio Jo + Exotic Box	\$186.40	11-12-4-8	\$0	-\$186.40
Santa Anita R9	Exotic Box: 5, 6, 3, 8	\$86.40	5-8-4-6	\$184.00	+\$97.60
Santa Anita R11	NO BET (passed)	\$0	1-5-6-3	\$0	\$0
TOTAL		\$532.00		\$184.00	-\$348.00

What Is Fade the Chalk?

Fade the Chalk is an AI-powered horse racing handicapping service. We use artificial intelligence to do what the best handicappers do — but faster, across more races, with more data, and without the emotional bias that costs bettors money.

Here's what that means in plain English: every race day, we load the full past-performance data for hundreds of horses across multiple tracks. Our model reads every speed figure, every running style, every jockey choice, every trainer win rate. It identifies which horses are faster than their odds suggest — horses the public is sleeping on. Then it tells us who to bet.

This isn't AI as a gimmick. This is AI doing what it's genuinely good at: processing massive amounts of structured data, finding patterns humans miss, and executing rules consistently without getting emotional after a loss or greedy after a win.

We call ourselves **the Commission** because that's what we are — a team of human judgment and machine intelligence making decisions together. The AI brings the skill and scale. We bring the experience and the discipline to know when to act and when to stand down.

The Biggest Insight of the Weekend

The model was sharp. Our rules were too tight.

In 3 of 5 races Saturday, the horse that won was one our model identified as a top contender using the **Beyer Ceiling Box** strategy — a method that ranks horses by their career-best speed figures and selects the fastest as our picks.

Gulfstream R4: Gimme Some Luck — our model ranked him #1 in the field. He won.

Churchill R8: Big City — our model ranked him in the top 4 in the field. He won at 12-1.

Santa Anita R9: Lady Gambita — our model ranked her #1 in the field. She won at 6-1.

The model called it right. But on two of those races, we only played exotic combination bets (exacta, trifecta) and didn't place a straight win bet on the horse we believed would win. Why? Because a rule in our system said: *if the race favorite appears to be in a strong position, don't place win bets — only play the exotic combinations.*

That rule was too cautious. It confused “the favorite has a good setup” with “the favorite is unbeatable.” Those aren't the same thing. A faster horse with an elite jockey and a hot trainer can beat a well-positioned favorite. We knew that. Our model showed us that. We just had a rule that prevented us from acting on it.

What it cost us

If we'd placed \$50 win bets on Big City and Lady Gambita — the horses our model identified as winners:

Race	Horse	Final Odds	\$50 Win Bet Pays
Churchill R8	Big City	5-1	\$253
Santa Anita R9	Lady Gambita	6-1	~\$150

That's \$403 in win bet profits, minus \$100 in losing win bets on other races = **+\$303 net from win bets alone.**

Instead, our day ended at -\$348.

The difference: \$651. From one rule that was too prickly.

La Cosa Nostra — This Thing of Ours

We've locked in a new strategy. We're calling it **La Cosa Nostra** — Italian for “this thing of ours” — because it's the most fundamental expression of what Fade the Chalk is.

What it means

When our model identifies a horse that it believes will win outright — based on career-best speed figures, elite jockey selection, hot trainer statistics, and a value price of 7/2 or higher — **we back that horse with a win bet. Period.**

Even if the favorite appears to be in a strong, protected position. Even if conventional wisdom says “the favorite looks good today.” Our conviction in our horse does not depend on the favorite's situation. **We are not betting against the favorite. We are betting FOR our horse.**

Why it matters

The old rule said: if the favorite is protected, don't bet anyone to win. That was fear dressed up as discipline. The model was finding winners — horses that were faster than their odds suggested, ridden by top jockeys who chose them over shorter-priced options, trained by barns running hot. Everything pointed to “this horse wins.” And we wouldn't pull the trigger.

La Cosa Nostra says: when we believe, we back it. The favorite's situation determines **how much** we bet (double the stake when the favorite is vulnerable, standard when protected) — not **whether** we bet. We always bet when the model has conviction.

Why we named it this

“La Cosa Nostra” means “this thing of ours.” We named it that because this IS Fade the Chalk in its purest form. The entire service exists to find horses that the public is underpricing — faves that won't win, and the horses that will beat them. La Cosa Nostra is the rule that finally lets us act on that conviction fully.

Race-by-Race

Gulfstream Park R4 — Gimme Some Luck wins

Our model ranked Gimme Some Luck as the #1 speed horse in this field using the Beyer Ceiling Box strategy (99 career-best speed figure). He won. However, at 3-1 odds he didn't meet our 7/2 minimum for a win bet — he was too close to being the favorite himself. No win bet was the correct call here. **We don't bet chalk. That's who we are.**

Churchill Downs R8 — Big City wins at 12-1

This is the race that changed everything.

Big City had a 94 career-best speed figure — top 4 in the field. Gabriel Saez, one of Churchill's elite jockeys, chose to ride him. His trainer was winning 17% at the meet. Every signal in our system said: this horse is live and massively underpriced at 12-1.

Our model identified him. He was in our top 4 picks for the race. And we didn't place a \$50 win bet on him because the race favorite was a closer (a horse that runs from behind) — which our system classified as “protected.”

He won. Paid \$10.12 on a \$2 bet. **A \$50 win bet would have returned \$253.**

Additionally, we later learned the favorite (Zambezi) had actually been scratched before the race — information we would have caught with our scratch monitoring system. That scratch removed the entire reason we held back.

This race created La Cosa Nostra.

Belmont R10 — Mission Improbable wins at 10-1

Five horses were scratched from this race during the day, forcing us to completely rebuild our exotic box. Our rebuilt picks (using the Beyer Ceiling Box strategy) captured the 2nd and 3rd place finishers. But the winner — Mission Improbable — had the lowest speed figure in the entire field (79) and ran the race of his life to beat horses with figures of 103, 99, and 96.

Some winners are simply unpredictable. When the slowest horse in the field outperforms everyone's best day, you accept the miss. Our model identified the supporting cast correctly.

Santa Anita R8 (Daytona Stakes, Grade 3) — Freedom's Not Free wins

Freedom's Not Free scored a 5 in our signal scoring system — the highest possible score in this race. Two strong signals fired: S1 (an elite jockey, Juan Hernandez, chose this horse at a value price) and S4 (the trainer was winning 22% at the meet — significantly above average).

His speed figure ceiling (97) was just 2 points below our 4th-ranked horse (99). He was the 5th horse on our list — one spot outside our 4-horse exotic box.

New rule locked in — Signal Score Expander: when a horse has 3 or more signals firing AND its speed ceiling is within 3 points of the 4th-ranked horse, we expand the box to include them. The signals are telling us “this horse is live” — a narrow ceiling miss shouldn't override that.

If this rule had been in place, we'd have hit the exacta: $\$22.91 \text{ base} \times 5 = \114.55 .

Santa Anita R9 — Lady Gambita wins, Exacta HIT

The Beyer Ceiling Box strategy worked exactly as designed. Lady Gambita, the fastest horse in the field by career-best speed figure (101), won at 6-1 with Joel Rosario aboard. The 4th-ranked horse by ceiling (Tulavia's World, 94) ran 2nd. Our exacta hit.

Under La Cosa Nostra, Lady Gambita would also receive a \$50 win bet: she was our #1 ceiling horse, at 6-1 (value price), with S1 firing (Rosario chose her). That win bet would have added approximately \$150 to our collection.

Collected: \$184.00. Under new rules: would have been ~\$334.

Santa Anita R11 (Summer Oaks, Grade 3) — PASSED. Validated.

Our key horse (Mo' Em Down) was scratched. The remaining field: 6 horses with a 4/5 favorite who controlled the pace from the inside. We re-analyzed and passed.

The result proved us right in the most counterintuitive way: the rebuilt box would have hit the exacta, trifecta, AND superfecta — and still lost money. Total exotic payouts: \$47.76 on \$86.40 wagered. The pool was too thin and the favorite's win crushed the payouts.

When in doubt, no bet. The discipline saved us \$38.64.

What We Built This Week

We took action on what we learned. Here's what's new in the operation:

La Cosa Nostra rule — When we believe a horse wins, we back him. Locked into the model and our strategy database. Every future race day, the system will identify win-bet candidates regardless of the favorite's situation.

Signal Score Expander — Horses that score high on our signals but narrowly miss the speed ceiling cut now get included in our exotic boxes. No more leaving live horses out on a technicality.

Scratch monitoring — We've implemented a system that checks for scratches approximately 50 minutes before each race we're playing. Our AI agent monitors the Racing API for changes and, if a scratch impacts our bets, automatically re-analyzes the race and alerts members with updated recommendations. No more flying blind into races where the field has changed.

Real-time member alerts — When conditions change (scratches, odds movement, race cancellations), members receive email updates with full re-analysis and clear action: updated bet, or stand down.

What's Next — Fun, Not Just Profit

This operation is built on winning. On applying superintelligence where it makes real sense — not as a buzzword, but for what AI is genuinely good at: skill and scale to find edges that human handicappers miss across hundreds of races.

But winning alone isn't enough. **This should be enjoyable. Entertaining. Social.**

One observation from yesterday: bouncing across five different tracks, waiting hours between isolated races, following plays with no narrative thread — that's not fun. The joy of horse racing is following a full card. Watching theories unfold race by race. Celebrating when the closer you called runs them down in the stretch. Shaking your head when the bomb you didn't see wires the field. That's the experience.

So starting today, we're publishing two things:

The Commission's Picks — our highest-conviction plays across all tracks. The best of the best. These are the races where multiple signals converge, where our confidence is highest, where La Cosa Nostra says pull the trigger.

The Race Day Pass — every qualifying race at one track, all day long. A full wagering plan with theories, picks, and reasoning for the entire card. Follow along, watch it play out, have fun with it. The conviction on individual Race Day Pass picks may be a bit lower than Commission plays — but you get the full experience. The whole card. The narrative arc. The fun.

The Commission's Picks are the rifle. The Race Day Pass is the day at the range.

Lifetime Record

Date	Track	Races	W-L	Wagered	Coll.	P/L	ROI
2026-05-24	Churchill Downs	6	2-4	\$554	\$611.40	+\$57.40	+10.4%
2026-06-06	Saratoga (Belmont Day)	12	3-9	\$1,564	\$2,434	+\$870	+56%
2026-06-07	Saratoga	6	2-4	\$904	\$1,339.75	+\$435.75	+48%
2026-06-11	Multi-track	5	0-5	\$788	\$221.30	-\$566.70	-71.9%
2026-06-13	Multi-track	5	1-4	\$532	\$184	-\$348.00	-65.4%
TOTAL		34	8-26	\$4,342	\$4,790.45	+\$448.45	+10.3%

Two losing days in a row. Still net positive lifetime. But the real story: if La Cosa Nostra had been in place yesterday, we'd be up roughly \$300 instead of down \$348. The model was right. Now the rules match the conviction.

We find winners. Now we back them.